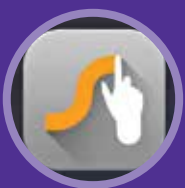


DOES THIS SECTION EVEN NEED AN INTRODUCTION? FROM COMPUTERS TO MOBILES, AND HEADPHONES TO GPUS, IT'S ALL HERE...

COOL DOWN

THIS MONTH IN TECH:

We take a look at the cool tech used to keep our gadgets cool. Then we head to the workshop for some Android home-screen customisation. After that, optimise your PC's airflow in Level-Up.



Swype Keyboard RIP

Nuance, the parent company for the iconic Swype keyboard that pioneered the swipe-to-type input method that we're all so familiar with now, has officially discontinued the Android and iOS apps for it.

<http://dgit.in/deadswype>

WHAT'S NEW

First Hyperloop in India?

Hyperloop technology has been on every analyst's radar ever since successful trials were completed for the rapid transportation technology. Numerous companies have started vying for contracts to be the first to get a commercial service started and it seems like India might be the first to get one running.

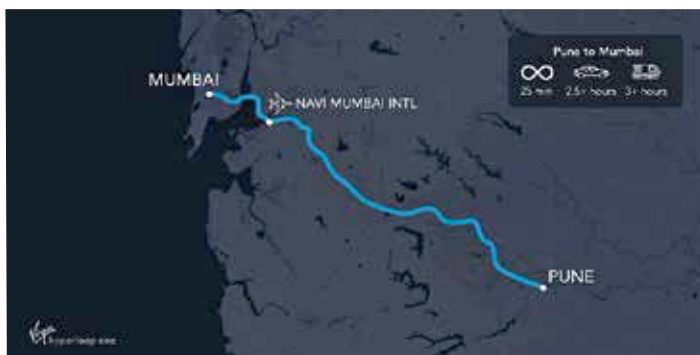
Virgin Hyperloop One is one of the many companies that's got a successful prototype running and they've recently entered into an agreement with the state of Maharashtra to build a test track. If all goes well, we could see the first Hyperloop service commence between the cities of Mumbai and Pune.

Virgin Hyperloop isn't the first to make such an announcement, in fact, last September we saw Hyperloop Transportation Technologies sign an agreement with the state of Andhra Pradesh to build a Hyperloop service between the cities of Amravati and Vijayawada. HTT is also building a Hyperloop in Korea, while Hyperloop One is in the process of building a track in Dubai. Virgin has already built a functional test track in the Nevada desert.

Coming back to the Virgin Hyperloop agreement, the service is planned to reduce the travel time between the two cities down to

as little as 25 minutes. The service is being explored as both, passenger transit and light freight transportation. Currently, it takes about 2 hours to travel from Mumbai to Pune.

Virgin Hyperloop One chairman, Richard Branson has written on Virgin.com that "I believe Virgin Hyperloop One could have the same impact upon India in the 21st century as



trains did in the 20th century." Branson also indicated that the track was the first corridor of a pan Indian Hyperloop network. Although this route is shorter than other alternatives proposed earlier, an ambitious Mumbai-Chennai route, it would still connect two cities with an aggregate population of around 25 million, that is projected to grow further steadily.

We certainly are excited to see not one but two Hyperloop services being planned in the country. What about you?

<http://dgit.in/2F3dPdp>



Sony's own AI Uber

Competing against Uber and Didi Chuxing, Sony corporation has announced a cab service in Japan, in partnership with licensed taxi service providers. The AI based platform will manage demand based on factors like weather, traffic and local events.

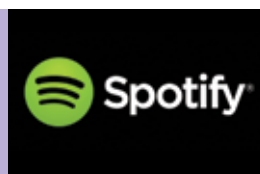
<http://dgit.in/sonycabs>



Facebook's two-factor snail mail

Advertisers for political campaigns, who intend to put the name of a candidate into an advertising campaign on Facebook, will now have to enter a code that will be generated and sent to them via postcard to prevent external interference.

<http://dgit.in/fbsnailmail>



Spotify hardware

New job listings posted by music streaming company Spotify indicate that it is in preparations to launch its first hardware product. Speculation for what the product may be ranges from Spotify integrated headphones, standalone speakers, or an AI powered smart speaker.

<http://dgit.in/sptfyspkr>